

# Launch readiness checklist

Everything that needs to be in place before taking a \$499+/month payment from a real company.

47

TOTAL ITEMS

7

SECTIONS

P1

DO FIRST

P3

CAN WAIT

## Product — Demo must be flawless PRIORITY 1

- ☐ **Demo database with sample data** — pre-loaded Postgres with realistic sales, finance, pipeline, support tables. 5-6 tables minimum.
- ☐ **One-click demo flow** — prospect clicks "Try a live demo" → sees a real question answered against sample data → report in under 60 seconds.
- ☐ **Connection onboarding wizard** — paste connection string → discover tables → confirm scope → done. Must feel safe and fast.
- ☐ **Read-only enforcement visible in UI** — show the SQL that ran. Show it's SELECT only. This is the #1 objection. Address it before they ask.
- ☐ **Report quality at consultant level** — professional formatting, charts, findings, and actionable recommendations. This is what they pay for.
- ☐ **PDF export working** — every report downloadable as a polished PDF they can forward to their board.
- ☐ **Email delivery** — reports delivered to inbox, not just viewable in the app.
- ☐ **Scheduled reports end-to-end** — set a weekly schedule, receive report on time. This is the sticky feature that prevents churn.
- ☐ **Follow-up / clarification flow** — after a report, user asks "Why did churn spike in March?" and gets a grounded follow-up.
- ☐ **Error handling** — LLM failure, DB timeout, or empty results show a professional message, never a stack trace.
- ☐ **Progress indicators** — for a 20-30s pipeline, show: "Scoping your question..." → "Analyzing data..." → "Building report..." Not a spinner.
- ☐ **Mobile-responsive reports** — executives read reports on their phone at 11pm.

## Security & trust PRIORITY 1

- ☐ **SSL/TLS everywhere** — HTTPS on all endpoints. Encrypted database connections.
- ☐ **Read-only SQL guarantee documented** — written policy and technical enforcement. Visible in the product.
- ☐ **Data handling policy** — what do you store? Query results? For how long? Write it down, publish it.
- ☐ **Query audit log** — every SQL query run, when, by whom, visible to the customer. Your governance differentiator.
- ☐ **Terms of Service** — reviewed by a lawyer. Covers data handling, liability, SLA commitments.
- ☐ **Privacy Policy** — GDPR-aware even outside EU. Your customers' customers may be in the EU.
- ☐ **Security one-pager PDF** — 1-page answering: "How does Claritect handle our data?" Pre-empts the security review.
- ☐ **SOC 2 readiness** — not SOC 2 itself yet. Access logging, encryption at rest, audit trail. Document your practices.

## Infrastructure — Production-ready

PRIORITY 1

- ☐ **Production deployment** — proper VPS or cloud instance with a deploy pipeline. Not running on your laptop.
- ☐ **Custom domain** — app.claritect.ai or similar. Not a platform subdomain.
- ☐ **Automated daily backups** — DB snapshots. Test a restore at least once before launch.
- ☐ **Uptime monitoring** — Uptime Robot (free) or Better Uptime. Know before your customer does.
- ☐ **Error alerting** — Sentry or similar. Get notified when the API, LLM, or worker breaks.
- ☐ **Usage metering per tenant** — track queries per tenant per month. Required for caps and overage billing.
- ☐ **Rate limiting per tenant** — prevent one user from burning your entire OpenRouter quota.
- ☐ **Environment separation** — production + staging at minimum. Never test on the live system.

## Website &amp; marketing

PRIORITY 2

- ☐ **Marketing homepage** — in progress
- ☐ **Pricing page** — in progress
- ☐ **One-pager pitch PDF** — done
- ☐ **3 example reports on website** — a finance report, an ops report, and a business case. Show what Claritect delivers. These sell harder than copy.
- ☐ **30-second product video** — screen recording: question typed → report appears. Embed on homepage hero.
- ☐ **2-3 minute demo video** — full walkthrough for people who want depth. YouTube + embed on site.
- ☐ **Blog with 2-3 SEO articles** — "How to automate executive reporting", "AI vs hiring a data analyst", etc.
- ☐ **Favicon, Open Graph tags, meta descriptions** — looks professional when shared on Slack, Twitter, email previews.

## Sales process

PRIORITY 1

- ☐ **Pilot booking flow** — "Book a Live Pilot" → Calendly or Cal.com → 30-min slot. Zero friction.
- ☐ **Pilot demo script** — what you walk through in 30 minutes. Rehearsed 5+ times. Demo with sample data first, then offer to connect their data live.
- ☐ **5 killer demo questions prepared** — Finance: margin shift. Ops: supplier underperformance. Product: release impact. Strategy: APAC business case. Scheduled: weekly pipeline summary.
- ☐ **Backup demo recording** — if live demo fails (LLM timeout), switch to a pre-recorded walkthrough seamlessly.
- ☐ **Follow-up email template** — sent within 1 hour of pilot. Summary of what you showed, link to their report, pricing, next steps.
- ☐ **Proposal template** — 1-page PDF: what they get, price, timeline, terms. Not a 20-page SOW.
- ☐ **ROI calculation ready** — "You spend X on consulting today. Claritect gives you the same for \$499/month." Have the math on screen.
- ☐ **CRM** — even a spreadsheet. Track: who, what stage, follow-up date. Graduate to HubSpot free at 20+ leads.

**Legal & billing** PRIORITY 2

- ☐ **Business entity registered** — you're charging \$500+/month. You need a proper company (LLC / Ltd).
- ☐ **Business bank account** — separate from personal. Required for Stripe payouts.
- ☐ **Stripe account verified** — test a real payment end-to-end. Set up the 3 subscription plans.
- ☐ **Professional invoices** — Stripe generates these, but verify they have your logo and look right.
- ☐ **Cancellation flow** — how does a customer cancel? Make it easy. Don't be the product that's hard to leave.
- ☐ **Refund policy** — "Not happy in the first 30 days? Full refund." Reduces purchase risk significantly.
- ☐ **Contract template** — simple SaaS agreement. Month-to-month to reduce friction. Annual discount (2 months free) available.

**Post-launch — first 30 days** PRIORITY 3

- ☐ **Customer onboarding email sequence** — after sign-up: connect DB → first report → set up schedule → add team members. Automated 4-email drip.
- ☐ **Weekly check-in with first 5 customers** — 15-min call. "What's working? What's not?" This feedback is gold.
- ☐ **Usage dashboard for yourself** — see per-tenant: queries this month, LLM cost, reports generated. Spot problems before customers complain.
- ☐ **Collect testimonials** — ask happy customers for a 2-sentence quote. Use on website and PH listing.

**Execution order**

Don't try to do everything at once. Ship in this order:

**Week 1-2: Foundation**

- ☐ Demo database + demo flow
- ☐ Production deployment + domain
- ☐ Stripe billing
- ☐ Pilot booking (Calendly)
- ☐ Pilot script rehearsed

**Week 3-4: Trust & credibility**

- ☐ Security one-pager
- ☐ Terms of Service + Privacy Policy
- ☐ 3 example reports on website
- ☐ Product video (30s + 3min)
- ☐ Usage metering + rate limiting

**Week 5-6: Go to market**

- ☐ Product Hunt launch
- ☐ Show HN post
- ☐ Cold email batch 1
- ☐ Community posting begins
- ☐ Google Ads live

**Week 7-8: Iterate**

- ☐ First customer onboarded
- ☐ Weekly check-ins running
- ☐ Blog posts + SEO
- ☐ Newsletter sponsorship
- ☐ Collect first testimonials